BASE 67

THE PROLOGUE

FOUR ASTRONAUTS. ONE HOSTILE WORLD. A FUTURE STILL WORTH FIGHTING FOR.

STORY & GAMEPLAY INTRODUCTION

Scene 1 — The Last Year

BLACK SCREEN.

A television broadcast fades in. The sound is faint, almost distant.

NEWS PRESENTER (V.O.)
"Good evening. We begin tonight with an urgent update from the International Climate Emergency Council. Scientists warn that a chain reaction of climate disasters is accelerating faster than expected. Food production is failing, freshwater supplies are shrinking, and extreme weather is disrupting life across the globe."

The screen cuts to images of flooded cities, dried reservoirs, burning forests, and crowded evacuation centres.

The broadcast returns to the presenter.

NEWS PRESENTER (V.O.)
"Governments worldwide have declared a state of emergency. Despite international efforts, the situation continues to deteriorate."

A pause.

The presenter looks directly into the camera.

NEWS PRESENTER (V.O.)
"Officials now warn that Earth may become unable to sustain human civilization within the next year."

The broadcast falls silent for a moment.

NEWS PRESENTER (V.O.)
"With humanity facing an uncertain future, the world's attention is turning beyond Earth. Scientists and space agencies are racing to determine whether another world could offer us a chance to survive."

The screen distorts.

Static.

Then complete silence.

TITLE CARD: **BASE 67**

Scene 2 — The Calling

INT. SPACE OPERATIONS FACILITY — NIGHT

A vast spacecraft stands inside an enormous hangar. Technicians move beneath its metallic frame while engineers monitor the final systems checks.

Beyond the glass walls, the night sky stretches endlessly.

The protagonist stands alone, gazing at the spacecraft.

For as long as they can remember, space has represented something greater than the world they know. The stars were never merely distant lights. They were destinations, mysteries, and possibilities.

Now, for the first time, the dream is within reach.

Footsteps approach.

The Commander of the space operations facility stops beside the protagonist.

COMMANDER
"Quite a sight."

The protagonist smiles faintly without taking their eyes off the spacecraft.

PROTAGONIST
"It's everything I imagined."

A beat.

PROTAGONIST
"Almost."

The Commander turns towards them.

COMMANDER
"Then you understand why I've called you here."

A holographic projection appears between them. Mars rotates slowly, its red surface illuminated by the display.

Four potential landing regions emerge.

COMMANDER
"Our first expedition lost contact seconds before touchdown. We received no landing confirmation. No distress signal. Nothing."

The four regions pulse on the display.

COMMANDER
"They could have landed anywhere within these zones. We don't know whether the crew survived."

The protagonist studies the map.

PROTAGONIST
"Then we find them."

COMMANDER
"That's the first objective. The second is to investigate possible signs of life and determine whether Mars can support a permanent human outpost."

The Commander expands the environmental data.

COMMANDER
"But understand what you're walking into. Radiation, extreme temperatures, dust storms. Limited power, water, food, and air. Every decision will have consequences."

The protagonist examines the four regions carefully.

PROTAGONIST
"Then we'll make every resource count."

The Commander brings up a mission profile.

COMMANDER
"Your transport has a strict cargo limit. You'll have to decide what the mission needs most. You'll also receive a personalized AI assistant, Dave. He'll monitor your systems, track resources, analyse threats, and help you make informed decisions."

PROTAGONIST
"And the final call?"

COMMANDER
"Always yours."

The protagonist looks again at Mars.

PROTAGONIST
"Earth has given us a year. We can't afford to waste it."

The Commander watches them for a moment.

COMMANDER
"You know this mission may cost you everything."

The protagonist turns to face the Commander.

PROTAGONIST
"I know."

A beat.

PROTAGONIST
"But if there's a chance to save our people, find something that changes our future, or build a place where humanity can survive… I'm taking it."

The Commander extends a hand.

COMMANDER
"Are you ready to take command?"

The protagonist shakes it firmly.

PROTAGONIST
"I'm ready."

COMMANDER
"Then there's one more thing. You may take three people with you. Choose carefully. Out there, they're more than your crew. They're the people you'll depend on when everything goes wrong."

The protagonist looks towards the spacecraft.

PROTAGONIST
"I already have three people in mind."

The Commander nods.

COMMANDER
"Then let's bring your team together."

CUT TO:

Scene 3 — Your Crew, Your Mission

INT. CREW PREPARATION FACILITY

Four astronaut silhouettes appear on a digital display.

One by one, their profiles illuminate.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Welcome, Commander. Crew configuration interface is ready. Please register your expedition personnel."

GAMEPLAY INTERFACE

The player enters the crew customization screen.

The player creates the four-person crew, including the protagonist.

Each astronaut can be customized through:

- Name and age
- Face and physical appearance
- Astronaut body and spacesuit appearance
- A special behavioral characteristic

The four crew members each have a role and personality that can influence how they respond to emergencies, manage stress, cooperate with others, and make decisions.

THE COMMANDER — THE DETERMINED LEADER

Profile	The protagonist is courageous, responsible, and focused under pressure. Their strength is the ability to keep moving when others lose hope. Their weakness is a tendency to carry every burden alone.
Special characteristic	**Unshakable** — Recovers from stress more efficiently.

THE ENGINEER — THE PRAGMATIST

Profile	Logical, resourceful, and direct. The Engineer keeps the outpost functioning, repairs damaged equipment, and finds solutions when systems fail. Their bluntness can create tension within the crew.
Special characteristic	**Technical Genius** — Repairs take less time or fewer spare parts.

THE SCIENTIST — THE CURIOUS IDEALIST

Profile	Curious, empathetic, and driven by discovery. The Scientist investigates unusual environmental evidence and potential signs of life, sometimes pushing the boundaries of safety.
Special characteristic	**Keen Observer** — Finds clues and useful environmental information more efficiently.

THE MEDIC — THE CREW'S ANCHOR

Profile	Compassionate, disciplined, and resilient. The Medic monitors the crew's health and morale, helping the team endure the psychological and physical pressures of Mars.
Special characteristic	**Field Medic** — Crew members recover from injuries and illnesses more efficiently.

> **GAMEPLAY INTERFACE**
> The player confirms the four profiles.

Their names appear together on the display.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Crew registration complete. Four personnel confirmed. Commander, your team is ready."

The screen fades into the red surface of Mars.

Scene 4 — Four Possible Worlds

INT. MISSION CONTROL — CONTINUOUS

A detailed holographic map of Mars fills the screen.

Four landing regions illuminate.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Landing-site selection initiated. Each region presents different environmental conditions, resource opportunities, and operational risks. Review the available assessments before confirming your destination."

> **GAMEPLAY INTERFACE**
> The player can examine each location, its difficulty rating, advantages, and disadvantages.

1. GALE CRATER — EASY

Description	A region of scientific interest with terrain that offers a comparatively manageable introduction to the mission.
Advantages	A useful starting point for scientific exploration and establishing initial operations.
Disadvantages	The selected route and surrounding terrain may restrict access to some resources and exploration areas.

2. ARCADIA PLANITIA — MEDIUM

Description	Broad plains that offer opportunities for establishing an outpost and investigating potential subsurface resources.
Advantages	Relatively open terrain and the possibility of valuable resources beneath the surface.
Disadvantages	Resource availability is uncertain, and environmental conditions may complicate long-term operations.

3. DEUTERONILUS MENSAE — HARD

Description	A rugged region of cliffs, landforms, and potential ice-bearing terrain.
Advantages	Possible access to water ice and scientifically valuable geological features.
Disadvantages	Difficult terrain, greater operational challenges, and potentially hazardous exploration.

4. EQUATORIAL PLAIN — EXTREME

Description	A demanding destination where survival depends on careful preparation and resource management.
Advantages	Potential opportunities for scientific investigation and a challenging environment in which to establish the outpost.
Disadvantages	Uncertain resources and environmental conditions that may place additional pressure on the crew and equipment.

DESIGN NOTE — PROVISIONAL

These descriptions are initial gameplay-design proposals. Final advantages and disadvantages should be aligned with the game's resource and environmental simulation.

GAMEPLAY INTERFACE

A countdown appears in the corner of the screen.

60 SECONDS REMAINING

The player moves between the four locations, comparing their assessments.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Commander, landing-site selection is required to calculate the final mission profile."

The timer continues.

GAMEPLAY INTERFACE

The player makes a choice.

If the countdown reaches zero without a selection, the system assigns a landing site at random. The player may end up at any difficulty level.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Landing zone confirmed. Mission parameters updated."

The chosen region expands across the display.

The camera moves closer until the red terrain fills the screen.

Scene 5 — Every Kilogram Counts

INT. CARGO PREPARATION BAY

Equipment containers stand in rows beneath the hangar lights. Robotic arms transfer supplies into the spacecraft.

A cargo manifest appears on the display.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Cargo allocation initiated. Transport capacity is limited. Commander, your equipment selections will determine the resources available to establish and maintain the outpost."

GAMEPLAY INTERFACE

The player must choose equipment while remaining within the mission's total cargo capacity.

The objective is not simply to carry as much equipment as possible. It is to balance immediate survival against the ability to remain operational over time.

POWER	Solar panels and batteries provide the foundation for the outpost's electrical systems.
FOOD	Greenhouse equipment supports food production and helps reduce dependence on supplies brought from Earth.
RADIATION PROTECTION	Shielding helps protect the crew from the dangers of the Martian environment.
REPAIRS	Spare parts allow the crew to repair damaged equipment and keep essential systems running.
AIR AND WATER	Life-support and water-management systems are critical to the crew's continued survival. *Their exact equipment requirements should be included in the finalized cargo inventory.*

GAMEPLAY INTERFACE

The cargo interface displays each item's name, weight, and contribution to the mission.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Cargo capacity is a mission constraint. Additional equipment may improve survival in one area while reducing the space available for another."

GAMEPLAY INTERFACE

The player adds and removes supplies.
The weight indicator changes with every decision.
A warning appears if the limit is exceeded.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Cargo capacity exceeded. Please revise your manifest."

GAMEPLAY INTERFACE

The player makes the final adjustments and confirms the loadout.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Cargo manifest confirmed. Mission equipment registered."

The robotic arms finish loading the spacecraft.

The cargo bay doors close.

Scene 6 — The Final Goodbye

INT. SPACE OPERATIONS FACILITY — LAUNCH PREPARATION AREA

The four astronauts stand before the Commander, now dressed in their launch suits.

For the first time, the mission feels real.

The Commander looks at each member of the crew before turning to the protagonist.

COMMANDER
"You've chosen your team. You've chosen your destination. And you've made your decisions about what to take."

A pause.

COMMANDER
"From here on, you'll face situations we can't predict and problems we can't solve for you."

The Commander extends a hand.

COMMANDER
"Good luck, Commander. Bring your crew home. And if you find a future out there… make it count."

The protagonist shakes the Commander's hand.

PROTAGONIST
"We will."

The four astronauts turn and walk towards the spacecraft.

The hangar doors begin to open.

Beyond them, the launchpad stretches into the dawn.

Scene 7 — Departure

EXT. LAUNCH FACILITY — DAWN

The spacecraft stands against the morning sky.

Inside the cockpit, the four astronauts secure themselves in their seats. Displays illuminate as the systems come online.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Crew status: confirmed. Life-support systems: operational. Navigation: ready. Mars transfer trajectory: calculated."

The protagonist looks through the cockpit window.

Earth fills the horizon.

A beautiful, fragile world.

A world they may never see again.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Commander, all systems are ready. Awaiting authorization."

The protagonist takes one final look at Earth.

PROTAGONIST
"Dave, initiate launch sequence."

DAVE (V.O.)
"Launch sequence initiated. Ten seconds to ignition."

The countdown begins.

MISSION CONTROL (V.O.)
"Five. Four. Three. Two. One. Ignition."

The engines ignite.

The spacecraft rises, climbing through the clouds as the launchpad disappears beneath it.

The atmosphere darkens.

The blue curve of Earth appears beyond the cockpit window.

The protagonist watches in silence as the planet grows smaller.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Earth departure confirmed. Mars transfer trajectory established."

The protagonist turns towards the darkness ahead.

PROTAGONIST
"Let's get to work."

CUT TO BLACK.

Scene 8 — Touchdown

INT. SPACECRAFT — MARS APPROACH

The red planet fills the forward display.

The crew braces as the spacecraft enters the atmosphere. Warning lights flicker briefly across the cockpit.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Atmospheric entry confirmed. Descent sequence active."

The spacecraft shakes violently.

Outside, a veil of dust sweeps across the Martian landscape.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Altitude decreasing. Landing zone approaching."

The engines roar against the red dust.

The ground rushes closer.

A final burst of thrust slows the descent.

Then—

IMPACT.

Silence.

A cloud of dust rolls past the cockpit windows.

The spacecraft settles onto the Martian surface.

For a few seconds, nobody speaks.

DAVE (V.O.)
"Touchdown confirmed. Mars surface contact established."

The protagonist looks out at the endless red landscape.

There is no familiar sky. No city lights. No sound of wind through trees.

Only a hostile world—and the fragile shelter they have brought with them.

The protagonist releases a slow breath.

PROTAGONIST
"All right, team. Let's build our future."

The camera pulls away from the spacecraft, revealing the vast Martian horizon.

The four astronauts are tiny against the immensity of the planet.

A final title appears.

BASE 67

THE MISSION BEGINS.

Appendix — Open Items and Production Notes

This appendix lists items the finalized draft marks as unresolved, plus gaps and inconsistencies found while producing this document. No values have been added or changed.

A. Marked as provisional in the finalized draft

- **Landing-site advantages and disadvantages (Scene 4).** The draft describes them as initial gameplay-design proposals; the final versions should be aligned with the game's resource and environmental simulation.
- **Air and water equipment (Scene 5).** The exact life-support and water-management equipment requirements are still to be included in the finalized cargo inventory.

B. Not specified in the finalized draft

- **Cargo capacity and item weights.** The draft states that transport capacity is limited and that the interface displays each item's weight, but gives no capacity figure or per-item weights (solar panels, batteries, greenhouse equipment, radiation shielding, spare parts, life-support and water-management systems).
- **Size of special-characteristic effects.** Unshakable, Technical Genius, Keen Observer, and Field Medic are described qualitatively ("more efficiently", "less time or fewer spare parts") without numeric values. For Technical Genius, it is not stated whether the benefit is time, spare parts, or both.
- **Landing-site mechanics.** Beyond the descriptions in Scene 4, no resource deposits, numeric modifiers, or penalties are defined for any site.

C. Production notes (document only; story unchanged)

- **Use of "Commander".** The facility Commander and the protagonist are both addressed as "Commander" (Scenes 3 and 6). Kept as written.
- **Launch countdown (Scene 7).** Dave announces "Ten seconds to ignition", while Mission Control counts down from five. Kept as written.
- **Spelling and typography.** British spelling in the draft (centres, analyse, towards) is retained. Straight quotation marks and apostrophes were converted to typographic ones, and the "---" separators were replaced with page breaks.